Templyworks

SETUP & USER GUIDE

Second Brain

Your second brain — finally organised.

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Notion template · Version Oct 2026

Welcome

Capture anything fast, sort it with the PARA method, keep ideas separate and document the processes you repeat.

What's inside

Inbox	The lowest-friction place to capture anything.
Ideas Vault	Business, template, content and product ideas.
SOPs	Step-by-step processes you repeat.
PARA Reference	Projects, Areas, Resources, Archive explained.

Get started in 5 minutes

1. **Duplicate the template**
   Open the template link from your delivery email. Click the ··· menu (top right) and choose **Duplicate** / **Duplicate to my workspace**. Work only in your copy.
2. **Clear or keep the examples**
   Every database ships with a few example rows so you can see how things connect. Look through them, then delete them (select rows → Delete) or overwrite them with your own data.
3. **Favourite the page**
   Click the star (☆) at the top so the template sits in your sidebar. On mobile, it then appears under Favourites.
4. **Capture five things**
   Add five items to **Inbox** right now — articles, notes, tasks, anything. Just a title is enough.
5. **Do your first sort**
   For each item set **PARA**, add **Tags** and a one-line **My Summary**, then tick **Filed**.
6. **Move ideas over**
   Anything that is an idea rather than a note goes into **Ideas Vault** with Status Raw.
7. **Write one SOP**
   Pick a task you do often (e.g. invoicing) and write its steps in a new **SOPs** page.

> **Good to know:** fields with a formula or rollup fill in by themselves — you never type into them. If one shows empty, the linked data (relation, date or amount) it needs is missing.

How it works

Inbox

- **Date Saved** fills in automatically when you create an entry.
- Capture first, organise later. Speed beats structure at capture time.
- Tick **Review This** for items you want to revisit; tick **Filed** once sorted — it leaves the Inbox view.

PARA method

- **Projects** — has a deadline and an outcome (e.g. client website, launch).
- **Areas** — ongoing responsibility with no end date (Finance, Health, Marketing).
- **Resources** — reference material by topic you want to find later.
- **Archive** — finished or inactive. Move here, don't delete.

Ideas Vault

- **Date Captured** fills in automatically.
- Status: Raw → Developing → Ready, or Shelved when it's not for now.

SOPs

- **Last Updated** changes automatically whenever you edit an SOP.
- Set **Owner** / **Delegate To** once someone else can run the process.
- Mark **Needs Update** when a process changed but the page didn't yet.

Your routine

Anytime	Capture into Inbox — phone or desktop.
Weekly review (15 min)	Open Inbox (not Filed). Give each item PARA, Tags and a summary, tick Filed. Skim Ideas Vault and move anything exciting from Raw to Developing.
Monthly	Archive finished projects, review SOPs marked Needs Update.

Pro tips

- Write My Summary in your own words — that is what makes notes useful later.
- Any process you repeat more than three times deserves an SOP.

FAQ

Which Notion plan do I need?	The free plan runs everything essential. Some view types (e.g. Charts) have limits on free plans; all core databases and formulas work without upgrading.
Can I rename or add properties?	Yes. If you rename a property that a formula or rollup uses, Notion updates the reference automatically. Deleting such a property breaks the formula that depends on it.
What currency is used?	Amounts are plain numbers, so any currency works. If you want a symbol, open the property → Number format → pick your currency.
Something isn't working?	Email info@templyworks.com with a screenshot. We fix setup problems quickly.

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